

Receiving Deliveries and Cold-Chain Checks (Prep Station)

1) Purpose and Scope

Keep unsafe food out and protect the cold chain from truck to storage. This SOP covers all deliveries received by Prep: chilled, frozen, produce, dry, and live shellfish. Follow these steps before any product enters storage.

2) Owner and Roles

- Owner: Samuel Okafor (Sous Chef, Prep). Final authority on accept/reject.
- Primary receiver: Prep team on duty, led by Samuel or designated lead prep.
- Backup: Grill or Pastry lead may assist, but Prep owns the check-in and paperwork.

3) Tools and Setup

- Calibrated digital probe thermometer with alcohol wipes.
- Infrared thermometer for quick scans (verify with probe).
- Sanitizer bucket and clean towels.
- Receiving Log clipboard, pens, stamp/date labels, Sharpie.
- Scale for weight checks.
- Ice bath container for quick-chilling small borderline items if kept.
- Shellfish tag binder with sleeves (alphabetized by species), log sheets.

4) Receiving Flow (Do These Steps In Order)

1. Stage the delivery at the receiving area. Keep doors closed between loads. Do not block walkways.
2. Compare invoice to our purchase order: item, brand, pack size, quantity, and substitutions.
3. Visual check first: packaging intact, sealed, clean, no swelling, no leaks, no dents on cans, no torn cases.
4. Temperature check by product type (see table). Use IR for a quick scan, then probe the thickest part or between packs. Sanitize probe between items.
5. Record temps and findings on the Receiving Log for every TCS item (meat, seafood, dairy, cut produce, prepared foods) and for frozen items.
6. Decide accept/reject on the spot. Separate rejects from accepted items. Mark rejects and keep with the driver.
7. Handle shorts/overages/subs: note on invoice and Receiving Log. Call vendor while driver is present if needed.

8. Move accepted product immediately to the correct storage: freezer, walk-in, low-boy, or dry. Do not leave TCS food on the dock.
9. Label all accepted product with received date and prep/use-by date if opened. Rotate FIFO (first in, first out).
10. Finish paperwork: sign invoices and the Receiving Log. Samuel (or lead prep) signs. Driver signs for credits.

5) Temperature Targets and Where to Probe

Product	Accept Temp	Probe Point/Notes
Refrigerated TCS (meat, poultry, seafood, dairy, cut produce, prepared foods)	$\leq 41^{\circ}\text{F}$	Between packages or center of largest unit. Poultry: deepest breast. Milk/yogurt: open a unit if seal allows; otherwise between containers in middle of case.
Eggs (shell)	Air temp $\leq 45^{\circ}\text{F}$	Insert probe between eggs in center of case; do not crack eggs.
ROP/Vacuum-packed chilled items	$\leq 41^{\circ}\text{F}$	Between packs in middle of case. Check seal integrity.
Frozen foods	$\leq 0^{\circ}\text{F}$ and solid hard-frozen	Probe center of case; product must be hard with no thawed edges or large ice crystals.
Ice cream/sorbets	$\leq 0^{\circ}\text{F}$, no softness	Press container lid; should be rigid. Probe if possible.
Live shellfish (in shell)	Air/wet temp $32\text{--}45^{\circ}\text{F}$	Do not submerge sealed bags. Shells closed or close when tapped.
Shucked shellfish	$\leq 41^{\circ}\text{F}$	Probe center pack; check label for pack date.

Reject if outside limits unless Samuel approves a safe corrective action (e.g., rapid chill of slightly warm produce that is not TCS). Never accept TCS above 41°F or frozen above 0°F .

6) Quality and Packaging Checks

- Meat/seafood: bright color, firm, no off-odors, no excessive purge, no sticky/slimy surfaces.

- Poultry: no tears, no standing purge, intact chill.
- Produce: crisp, clean, no decay or mold. Cut produce must be sealed and $\leq 41^{\circ}\text{F}$.
- Dairy: sealed, correct date, no bloating. Milk must be Grade A.
- Cans: no dents on seams, no swelling, no rust. Reject deep seam dents.
- ROP: seals tight, no bubbles, no leaks. If fish is ROP and labeled "Keep Frozen," do not accept thawed.
- Date codes: no expired or same-day "use by" unless pre-approved.

7) Live Shellfish Tag Control

11. On receipt, pull the harvester/dealer tag from each bag/container.
12. Record species, source, harvest area, and delivery date on the Shellfish Tag Log.
13. Store tags in the binder in order of use. Keep each tag for at least 90 days after the last of that lot is served.
14. Do not mix lots in the same tank or container without keeping tags together.
15. Reject if: missing tags, dead shellfish (do not close when tapped), strong off-odor, mud-packed with broken shells, temp above 45°F , or bags submerged and sealed.

8) Rejects, Short-Shipments, and Credits

- Reject criteria (any): temps above limits, damaged/leaking packages, adulteration, evidence of thaw-refreeze, pests, missing/incorrect tags or labels, wrong item, unsafe quality.
- Process to reject:
 1. Mark item as REJECTED with reason and temp.
 2. Photograph if needed.
 3. Note on invoice and Receiving Log (item, lot/date code, reason, temp).
 4. Driver signs the credit/return line. Keep a copy.
 5. Call vendor rep to confirm replacement/credit.
- Short-shipments/overages/substitutions:
 - Circle on invoice, write actual quantity received, and initial.
 - Log on Receiving Log with notes (e.g., "short 2 lb," "subbed brand X").
 - If sub is not approved, reject the sub and request the original item.

9) Labeling, Storage, FIFO, and Sign-Off

- Label each accepted case/unit: received date, opener's initials, and use-by if opened.
- Store immediately: freezer $\leq 0^{\circ}\text{F}$; walk-in $\leq 41^{\circ}\text{F}$; eggs at $\leq 45^{\circ}\text{F}$; dry goods off the floor on racks.
- FIFO:

- Pull older product to the front. Place new behind.
- Match lot codes and dates; do not mix open with sealed without dating.
- Trim and use first any produce with limited shelf life.
- Documentation:
 - Receiving Log entries include: vendor, driver, time in, item, quantity, temps, accept/reject reason, credits, initials.
 - Shellfish Tag Log completed for each lot.
 - Samuel Okafor (or designated lead prep) signs the Receiving Log and invoices after checks are complete.